Sangjun (Samuel) Ko

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Education

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign — Champaign, Illinois
Bachelor of Science in Statistics (CGPA: 3.93/4.00) — January 2023 - May 2025
- Mathematics Minor

Work Experience

Staffmark Group (on assignment at Kimberly-Clark) — Neenah, Wisconsin
Statistician — June 2025 - Present
- Design and run DOE experiments and curate home-use-test and lab data to build regression models that predict consumer perception from bench measurements, reducing reliance on expensive, multi-month consumer home-use testing
- Built and deployed leakageReport, a Flask-based statistical reporting module that replaced an outdated legacy system for mannequin leakage studies—continually improving reporting workflows for 50+ users; now the team standard
- Built and deployed 5 additional Python modules on an internal analytics platform, including a usage-tracking dashboard and predictive-modeling UIs, managing Git-based version control for the codebase and serving as the team's liaison to address structural data needs
- Lead or support 10+ concurrent Test Method Validation (TMV) and Gauge R&R studies (basis weight, tensile, caliper, tear strength, attribute inspection) across product lines, translating bias/precision results into pass/fail recommendations and spec-limit proposals

STAT107 Data Science Discovery — Champaign, Illinois
Undergraduate Course Assistant — August 2023 - May 2025
- Assisted over 300 students with fundamental data science concepts through interactive labs
- Managed Git for learning platform modifications, benefiting 1000+ students; create, edit, and proofread course materials

Applied Technologies for Learning in Arts & Sciences — Champaign, Illinois
AI/ML Intern Team Leader — January 2024 - December 2024
- Lead a team of 5 interns and collaborated closely with 3 coordinators in weekly meetings
- Built ML models with 100,000+ data points using Python and advanced techniques like XGBoost and BERT

Projects/Awards

Graduation Prediction Model
- Increased AUC score from 0.65 to 0.82 by reducing noise in the dataset through feature engineering and outlier removal across 50,000+ student records
- Built a Streamlit interface with 12 key predictors for real-time predictions for university administrators

3rd Place, 2024 COVID Information Commons Student Paper Challenge
- Analyzed the socioeconomic and mental health impacts of COVID-19 in Mexico, identifying that 42% of females and 40% of young adults faced job loss
- Proposed data-driven interventions to support vulnerable groups through geospatial and statistical analysis

Paraphrase Detection
- Achieved 90%+ accuracy in paraphrase detection using BERT, RoBERTa, and SBERT models on the MRPC dataset
- Developed a Gradio interface for real-time detection for easier evaluation of textual similarities

Skills

Languages:	English (Fluent), Spanish (Native), Korean (Native), French (Basic), Chinese (Basic)
Computer:	Python (Advanced): Pandas, NumPy, Scikit-learn, TensorFlow, NLTK, Matplotlib R (Intermediate): Tidyverse, ggplot2, dplyr, caret Flask (Intermediate), Git (Intermediate), SAS (Intermediate), SQL (Basic) Tableau (Basic), Office (Advanced)
Certificates:	Data Science Certificate, Coursera Business Analytics Certificate

Community Service and Extracurricular Activities

Volunteer, Appleton Public Library — August 2025 - Present
Consultant in Illinois Business Consulting — September 2024 - December 2024